YOUR PARENTING PROFILE



The Focaccia

F G D E

A forgiving dough, dimples, olive oil, learning by doing.

Your four letters

Your code is built from four research-backed parenting dimensions. Neither pole of any dimension is the better one.



F — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY
Flow

G — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION
Gardener

D — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG
Doer

E — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE
Explorer

For fun & reflection — not a clinical assessment or diagnostic tool.

AN EVERYDAY STORY

Mud on the Good Towels

After an afternoon in the garden, muddy footprints cross the floor and the good towels are brown at the edges. Your child is delighted. A visiting relative looks around and says, “You let the house get like this?” For a moment, your confidence folds. Maybe freedom is just another word for being careless.

As a Focaccia parent, you trust hands, dirt, weather, and trial and error. You know that learning can look untidy. Still, comparison with more controlled homes can make your generous looseness feel like a flaw.



Before cleaning, you step outside alone for three minutes of air. Then you return to the only three rules that matter here: protect bodies, respect people, help care for the shared space.

You and your child each take one towel and wipe one trail without a lecture. The house is still imperfect, but the responsibility is shared. Freedom did not vanish when structure arrived. It became safer. Like forgiving dough, your family can be pressed, stretched, and reshaped without needing every surface to stay untouched.



WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS

You trust children to learn from real life, soil, water, bodies, and trial and error. When the house is messy or others look more structured, comparison can turn into guilt.

RELEASE THE GUILT

Loose is not the same as neglectful. You do not have to copy another home; you only need a few boundaries that are truly kept.



YOUR SUPERPOWERS

1. Mess is your co-parent
2. Nature is your favorite classroom
3. You raise bounce-back kids by example

WATCH-OUT, WITH LOVE

Loose structure can become no structure. Three real house rules, max, but real. 🫒

YOUR POP-CULTURE COUSIN

Free-range parenting



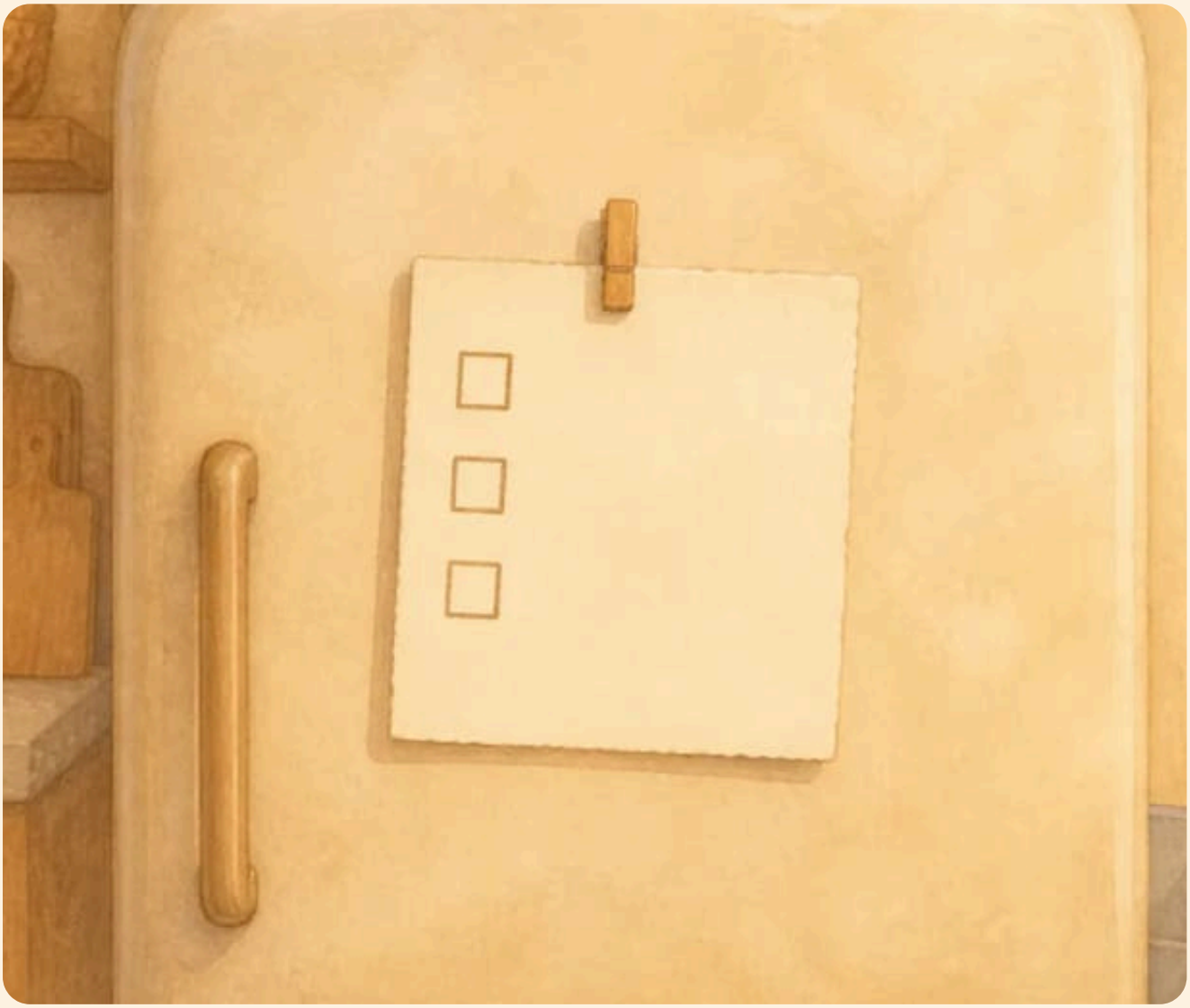
WHAT TO REMEMBER

Try this week

- [ ] Choose no more than three house rules
- [ ] Get outside for your own sake
- [ ] After a mess, repair one thing together without a lecture

EXTRAS FOR YOUR STYLE

- [ ] Pick one routine and keep it all the way to the weekend.
- [ ] Set one limit and hold it to the end.
- [ ] Before you fix it, say one feeling word first.
- [ ] Stop at the first try if they say that's enough.



FOR YOU FIRST

5 ways to come back to yourself

Chosen from your style: what you spend yourself on is what needs releasing. Not one of these is for your child.

There's an order most of us have backwards: everyone else gets looked after first, and you get whatever is left. But what's left at nine at night isn't you — it's the part of you that never got to rest.

The next five pages don't ask you to be a better parent. Nothing here is counted, nothing is reported, and not one of them is for your child. They're all for you, and they aren't a reward you have to earn first.

What's on them isn't random either. Every parenting style spends itself differently: some parents run out from anticipating, some from deciding, some from holding everybody's feelings. So whatever drains you most is also what most needs releasing.



WHAT DRAINS YOU MOST

F — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY

Deciding without a rail. Every hour asks for a fresh decision.

G — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION

Waiting and holding back. Following someone else's pace all day is work.

D — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG

Doing. Loving through action means you rarely get to sit down.

E — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE

Being the energy. Every bit of the fun sets off from you first.

FOR YOU FIRST

Spend time outside or move your body without turning it into your child's learning session.

HOW TO USE THESE

Take just one. If only one of these gets used this week, that worked. The rest stay here; they aren't going anywhere.

No time this week? You are still enough.



TIME 5 MIN

One drink while it's still hot

Almost every parent drinks their coffee cold. Not from lack of time, but because there is always one more thing that comes first.

Sit down. Finish the whole thing at its actual temperature, doing nothing else at the same time.



TIME 15 MIN

The basket that finds itself

Your rest often gets spent hunting for the things that make it rest. Recovery shouldn't need a search party.

One basket, one fixed place: your book, your charger, your hand cream, a snack that is actually yours.



TIME 15 MIN

Tend something that isn't your child

You're good at tending things that grow slowly. Fifteen minutes of care that reports to nobody and thanks you by growing.

Water the plants, prune something, feed the sourdough. Anything that grows and isn't your child.



TIME 15 MIN

Move for no output

Your body moves all day, but always while carrying or clearing something. Movement that isn't going anywhere feels different.

Stretch, walk, dance in the kitchen. Anything that isn't carrying, tidying, or getting somewhere.



TIME 2 MIN

Twenty minutes earlier

The next adventure is better funded by sleep than by will. This is two minutes of setting, not twenty of losing.

Set one alarm tonight — not to wake up, to stop.

5 activities with your child (0–5)

One for each age range, so you can take the one that fits your child right now. Everything is already in your house.



THEN, FOR YOUR CHILD

Freedom feels safer when your child knows three things do not change: what protects bodies, respects people, and cares for shared spaces.



0–12 MONTHS · 10 MIN

The texture tour

Naming what a baby is touching builds language long before they can talk.

1. Pick five safe textures: a curtain, a cool window, a wooden spoon, a leaf, a towel.
2. Let their hand land first, then name it.
3. Wait for their sound or look before moving on.

You'll need: Your own house.
Safety first: Skip anything hot, sharp, electrical, or small enough to fit through a toilet-paper tube.
Grounded in: Serve and return (Harvard)



1–2 YEARS · 10 MIN

Walk the tape line

One line becomes a balance beam, a road, or nothing at all. Whatever they turn it into is the activity.

1. Run a straight or curved line of tape along the floor.
2. Walk it once yourself, then stop directing.
3. Follow whatever rules they invent, even if they change every minute.

You'll need: Masking or washi tape.
Safety first: Clear the run of hard furniture corners. Bare feet or grippy socks.
Grounded in: Montessori — freedom of movement



2–3 YEARS · 10 MIN

Sort it your way

You supply the objects; they supply the rule. Their rule is the point.

1. Tip out 10–15 mixed household objects and two empty bowls.
2. Say "you can sort these however you like", then stay quiet.
3. If they sort by something you'd never have chosen, that's the successful version.

You'll need: Large buttons, bottle caps, spoons, blocks, socks.

Safety first: Every object must be too large for a toilet-paper tube and have no sharp edges. An adult stays with them.

Grounded in: Montessori — sensorial



3–4 YEARS · 15 MIN

You're the customer

For parents who show love by doing: here the doing is theirs, and you're the one being served.

1. They cook, you order and eat.
2. Accept whatever arrives, including the inedible parts of the game.
3. Slip in one feeling word somewhere: "you look proud of that one".

You'll need: Pots, spoons, cups — whatever is already in the toy box.

Safety first: Nothing from the real stove.

Grounded in: Filial therapy — special play time



4–5 YEARS · 15 MIN

The cushion course

They design it, you attempt it. Being the rule-maker is practice they rarely get.

1. They design the course and set the rules.
2. You go first, and follow their rules exactly.
3. Let them change the rules mid-course, because they will.

You'll need: Cushions, tape, chairs, a blanket.

Safety first: Use only stable, non-folding chairs. Nothing to climb higher than their own hip, with an adult staying close.

Grounded in: Montessori — freedom of movement



No play today? You are still enough.

Keep it, print it, or forget it

This booklet has no targets and counts nothing. Take the one thing that helps and leave the rest.



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